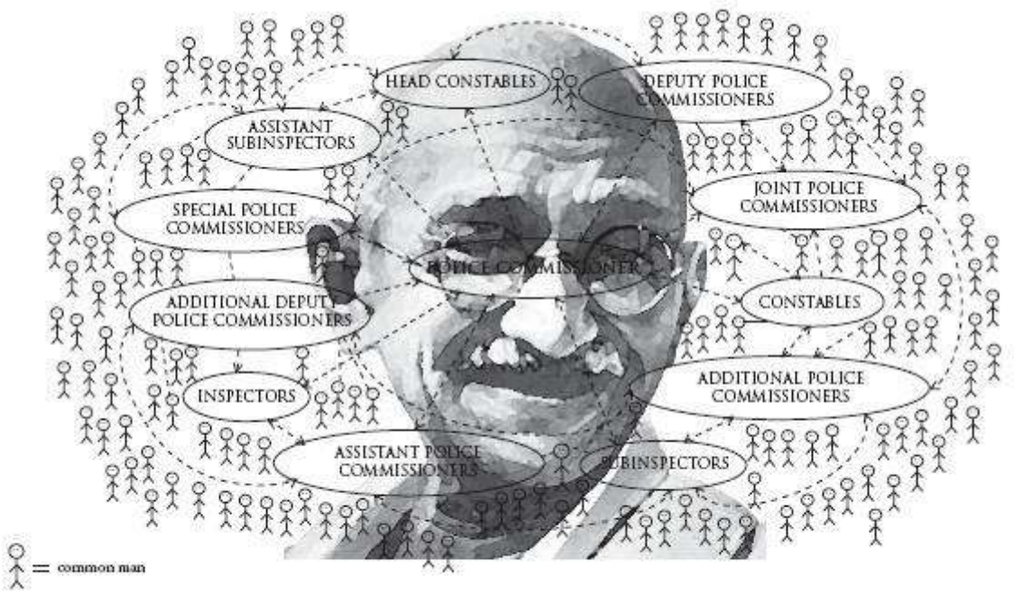


Synergized, Collective, Accessible

I would not have wasted a single moment but begun by laying the foundation, and recalling the basic principle, of sound policing, which is the revival of the police beat system along with the beat boxes (which had gone into erratic and inconsistent deployment) in police stations across Delhi (over 130; for the latest figure, please see the Delhi Police website). This move would have covered the entire city uniformly. Which would have meant responsibility being affixed for every inch of the city on the area beat police officers working in shifts and winning the trust and cooperation of the people. All this would have greatly helped in the prevention and early detection of crimes and also in enhancing the ground intelligence capacity. This would have been a paradigm shift from policing by control to policing by empowerment. Such an aligned and motivated organization would have always been ready to prevent or respond to any terror attack.

On this very foundation would have been built an architecture of sustained police–public partnership, which would have improved communication between both sides. It would have broken down the artificial barriers of hierarchy within the police.

Such positive developments would have led to more trust being engendered between the people and the police as also within the various ranks of the service. The beat system ensures that the people are listened to, supports their efforts and strengthens interaction between the police and the citizens. Most of all, this system stands for ‘policing as the power to prevent crimes’.

I would have undertaken daily field visits to ground units, planned or surprise, to listen to opinions and suggestions, and then analysing them and using them to resolve issues before they could become problems. I would have reached daily, any particular unit, by 9 a.m., to hear out the police personnel closest to the ground and to empower them to carry out their duties effectively. They would have been rewarded for good work right there and then. I had followed this very useful practice in all my field postings in the past and had reaped rich dividends. The focus was on doing and getting things done rather than asking for reports.

My focus on traffic management in Delhi would have been a major priority as everyone is impacted by chaotic and dangerous driving of vehicles. I would have provided non-sparing enforcement of traffic laws through more traffic cops on the roads, especially at night, when